Basic bidding Notrump raises Major suit raises

This set of practice deals focuses on basic bidding situations. There are no conventions used except for one deal which uses Blackwood. Even that is optional.

The deals are designed with the beginning player in mind, or perhaps those who feel the need to refresh themselves on the fundamentals of bidding.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in finding a fit and deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam.

Keep in mind:
- a combined 8-card trump fit is desired to play in a suit
- it takes 26 points to make game in Notrump or a Major suit
- it takes 33 points to make small slam

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣K

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦2

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 2♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♠9

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6NT
Declarer: West
Lead: ♦Q

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♥K

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠K

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

♠ Q J 10 8 3
♥ A J 4
♦ A 10
♣ 9 6 2

♠ 7 2
♥ 10 9 8 6 2
♦ 9 8 3
♣ A J 4



♠ 5
♥ 7 3
♦ 6 5 4 2
♣ K Q 10 8 7 5

♠ A K 9 6 4
♥ K Q 5
♦ K Q J 7
♣ 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♠	Pass	4NT[1]
Pass	5♥[2]	Pass	6♠
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♠ by North
Lead: ♣K

NORTH has a minimum 1♠ opening bid - 13 points and five trumps. She doesn't even suspect what's about to befall!

SOUTH hears the 1♠ bid and all he wants to know is whether NORTH has one, two or three Aces. So he uses the Blackwood convention, 4NT.

NORTH has two Aces so she bids 5♥ (5♣ would show zero Aces, 5♦ would show one Ace, etc).

SOUTH has heard enough and bids 6♠.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ Q 10 9 5 ♥ 10 3 ♦ Q J 9 ♣ K Q J 8	
♠ A 7 4 ♥ Q 5 ♦ K 7 6 4 ♣ 7 6 5 3		♠ 6 2 ♥ A K 8 7 6 2 ♦ A 10 3 ♣ A 9
	♠ K J 8 3 ♥ J 9 4 ♦ 8 5 2 ♣ 10 4 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
1NT	Pass	3♥	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			

4♥ by East
Lead: ♦2

EAST has an above-minimum strength hand with a good 6-card suit. He opens 1♥.

WEST, with 9 points, is a little too weak to bid at the 2-level so she bids a catchall 1NT.

EAST shows his 6-card suit and extra strength by jumping to 3♥, which WEST raises to 4♥ since two trumps is now adequate support.

Board 3
South Deals
E-W Vul

	♠ J 10 8 3 ♥ A Q 7 4 ♦ J 5 3 ♣ 7 6	
♠ 9 2 ♥ K 10 2 ♦ A 10 9 ♣ J 9 8 5 4	N W E S	♠ A 6 5 ♥ J 9 6 5 ♦ K Q 8 4 ♣ 10 3
	♠ K Q 7 4 ♥ 8 3 ♦ 7 6 2 ♣ A K Q 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♣
Pass	1♥	Pass	1♠
Pass	2♠		
All Pass			

2♠ by South
Lead: ♠9

SOUTH has 14 points and opens her 4-card ♣ suit.

NORTH must respond, and with two 4-card Majors bids them "up-the-line", saying 1♥.

SOUTH now shows his 4-card ♠ suit, and NORTH again must bid. Since NORTH is pretty weak he just raises to 2♠, which SOUTH happily passes.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

♠ 6 5 3
♥ 10 4
♦ Q J 9 5 2
♣ A 5 4

♠ K Q 7
♥ K Q J 3
♦ A 10 6
♣ Q 10 8



♠ A 9 4
♥ A 7
♦ K 8 3
♣ K J 9 6 2

♠ J 10 8 2
♥ 9 8 6 5 2
♦ 7 4
♣ 7 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	4NT	Pass
6NT			
All Pass			

6NT by West
Lead: ♦Q

WEST has a maximum 17 point 1NT bid.

EAST, with 16 points, can't tell if there are enough points for slam. If WEST has 17 points then a slam should be makeable, but if WEST has only 15 points then he should settle for game.

The 4NT raise solves the problem. It tells WEST to bid 6NT with 17 points, pass with 15 points, and use best judgment with 16. Here WEST bids the slam.

Board 5
South Deals
N-S Vul

♠ A Q 8 6 2
♥ J 5 3
♦ 7 4
♣ K Q 2

♠ J 10 4
♥ Q 7 6
♦ Q 10 9 6
♣ A 8 5



♠ 5
♥ A K 10 9
♦ J 8 3 2
♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ K 9 7 3
♥ 8 4 2
♦ A K 5
♣ J 7 6

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			Pass
Pass	1♠	Pass	3♠
All Pass			

3♠ by North
Lead: ♥K

SOUTH has just 11 points, not enough to open the bidding. But when NORTH opens 1♠ SOUTH should show her "almost opening strength" by jumping to 3♠.

NORTH has just 13 points, and knowing SOUTH has less than 13 he passes.

Board 6
East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A 9 6 5
♥ J 9
♦ 9 2
♣ A J 7 3 2

♠ 7 3
♥ Q 8 6 4 2
♦ A 8 6
♣ K 9 5



♠ 10 8 2
♥ A K 7 5 3
♦ K Q 5
♣ Q 6

♠ K Q J 4
♥ 10
♦ J 10 7 4 3
♣ 10 8 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♥	Pass
4♥			
All Pass			

4♥ by East
Lead: ♠K

After EAST opens with 1♥, WEST has a small "dilemma". With 11 points she really is only strong enough to make a jump raise to 3♥. But, with five trumps the hand deserves more. So she just bids 4♥ instead.

Usually, no matter what your strength, when you have five cards in the Major suit that your partner opens with you should just jump right to game.